commitment. The crowd reached a point dangerously close to the boundary they had set, where walking and standing were not allowed. Rahul Gandhi found himself pushing through the dense mass of people. At one juncture, it seemed that nothing could be done to avert a chaotic situation. I, too, found myself fatigued, navigating through a sea of people, and was genuinely concerned that another fall might be imminent, securing my place in heaven in the next few minutes. I had already escaped one such peril, thanks to Byju, who, in a fleeting moment, shielded me from a crowd rushing forward. The prospect of a stampede loomed large, making it seemingly impossible to reach the Red Fort. However, as always, Rahul's indomitable determination and courage prevailed, and the march reached the Red Fort as planned. His impassioned speech at the Red Fort undoubtedly became one of the defining moments of the entire march.

Nature graced us throughout the Yatra, reaching the pinnacle of beauty in Kashmir. Contrary to earlier fears of bone-chilling temperatures at minus 10 degrees, the cold was more bearable at only minus 1 or 2 degrees. The nights were a bit chilly, but by then our bodies had adapted to everything, from knee pain to the cold. The winter clothes purchased for the severe cold were peacefully resting in their boxes! The snow-covered road had been cleared for walking, and the snowfall on both sides created a picturesque yet poignant scene. In this land of pristine beauty, the presence of machine guns, always vigilant and directed at unsuspecting individuals, added a layer of heaviness to the mind—a sight unparalleled in any other segment of the Yatra, burdened by the weight of history.

Even before the Yatra officially commenced, crowds began descending on the slopes flanking both sides of the road. Within moments, thousands of people adorned in traditional Kashmiri attire congregated along the route. The unanticipated turnout left the police, unprepared for such a reception, standing still. It is no wonder that the inhabitants of this heavenly realm, yearning for love for half a century, greeted us with open hearts and bouquets of flowers, eager to witness the angel who had been spreading love throughout the country.